Flannery 2D

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An opening Flannery 2♦ bid shows 11-15 HCP with exactly four spades and five hearts. The purpose of Flannery is to avoid rebid problems with this hand type; a 1♥ opening sometimes leads to trouble when opener cannot bid 2♠ (a reverse) at his next turn.

Some examples of hands suitable for a Flannery 2♦ opening:

♠AKQ2 ♥A9854 ♦6 ♣732	♠J862 ♥KQT75 ♦93 ♣AQ	♠KJ75 ♥QJ963 ♦AJ42 ♣--

Responses to Flannery 2♦

The responses to the Flannery 2♦ opening are:

Response	Meaning
Pass	6+ diamonds, signoff
2♥	Natural, signoff
2♠	Natural, signoff
2NT	Strong, artificial and forcing, asking opener to further describe his hand (see below)
3♣	6+ (7+) clubs, signoff
3♦	6+ (7+) diamonds, invitational
3♥	3+ hearts, 10-12 points, invitational
3♠	4+ spades, 10-12 points, invitational
3NT	Natural, signoff
4♣	Transfer to 4♥
4♦	Transfer to 4♠
4♥	4+ hearts, signoff
4♠	4+ spades, signoff

Opener's Rebids After 2NT

After hearing an artificial 2NT response, opener must clarify his strength and distribution. This helps responder decide whether his own values are suitable for game or slam.

Opener's conventional rebids are as follows. "Minimum" strength indicates 11 to a bad 14 HCP, while "maximum" strength indicates a good 14 - 16 HCP.

Rebid	Meaning
3♣	4-5-1-3 shape. Responder can bid 3♥/♠ non-forcing with 10-12 points and trump support.
3♦	4-5-3-1 shape. Responder can bid 3♥/♠ non-forcing with 10-12 points and trump support.
3♥	4-5-2-2 shape, minimum strength. Responder can pass or correct to 3♠ non-forcing with 10-12 points and trump support.
3♠	4-5-2-2 shape, maximum strength. Forcing for one round.
3NT	4-5-2-2 shape, maximum strength, both minor suits stopped (Qx or better). Responder can pass or continue bidding.
4♣	4-5-0-4 shape. Forcing for one round.
4♦	4-5-4-0 shape. Forcing for one round.

Examples

Opener	Responder
♠AT98	♠KQ74
♥K5432	♥87
♦KQ	♦T76
♣J9	♣Q642

Opener	Responder
2♦ (1)	2♠ (2)
Pass	

1. Flannery
2. Taking a preference, signoff

Opener	Responder
♠KQJ7	♠5
♥AK765	♥Q82
♦9	♦KJ765
♣J43	♣AT92

Opener	Responder
2♦ (1)	3♥ (2)
4♥	

1. Flannery
2. Invitational, 10-12 points with at least 3-card support

Opener	Responder
♠J876	♠AT2
♥AJT93	♥K
♦A2	♦KQT85
♣A7	♣KQ65

Opener	Responder
2♦ (1)	2NT (2)
3NT (3)	Pass (4)
Pass	

1. Flannery
2. Strong, artificial and forcing
3. 4-5-2-2 shape, both minor suits stopped
4. Giving up aspirations of a minor-suit slam

The 4♣ and 4♦ Transfers

Readers will observe that responder can bid game in two ways: bidding 4♥/♠ directly, or transferring via ♣/♦.

In Bill Flannery's treatise "The Flannery 2D Open", the minor suit transfers are intended to protect any tenaces in opener's hand. Should responder have any tenaces worth protecting himself, he should consider transferring.

Flannery states, "Responder has complete discretion whether to transfer or to play game himself. He should generally transfer if his hand contains no tenaces (for example, Kx, AQx, KJx), since his partner's hand might contain such holdings."

Like the direct jumps to 4♥/♠, these transfers can either be weak (sacrificial) or strong (to play).

In Competition

In competition, the specialized Flannery responses and rebids are on. Any double of an opposing overcall does not indicate a 'stolen bid' but is for penalties.

Origins

Flannery is named for its inventor, American William Flannery.

See also

- Ekren 2♦
  A weak 2♦ opening bid showing 4-4 or longer in hearts and spades.
- Fighting Irish 2♦
  A weak 2♦ opening bid showing 4-3 or 4-4 in the majors.
- Multi 2♦
  An artificial 2♦ opening bid showing either a major suit preempt or a strong 4441 hand.
- Precision 2♦
  An artificial 2♦ opening bid from the Precision bidding system, showing a 3-suited hand with minimum strength.
- Roman 2♦
  An artificial 2♦ opening bid from the Italian Blue Team bidding system, showing a strong 3-suited hand.